

**ECON 2CC3: Health Economics and its
Application to Health Policy**

Spring 2026

Instructor Information

Instructor Name: Paul Contoyannis

Email: contoyyp@mcmaster.ca

Office hours: Posted on Avenue to Learn (A2L)

Course Information

Lectures: see Avenue to Learn (A2L) or MOSAIC for times and classroom information

Labs: No

Tutorials: No

Course Dates: 2026/05/04- 2026/06/19

Units: 3.0

Course Delivery Mode: Online

Course Description: Economic analysis of health and health care, with a special emphasis on policy issues in the Canadian health care system.

Hours of Study: 6 hours per week

Instructor-Specific Course Information

This course is an introduction to health policy analysis using the lens of microeconomics. The course is designed to show that many apparently complex issues in health policy can be greatly clarified when they are analyzed using principles of microeconomics. We begin with an overview of health and health care systems with an emphasis on the Canadian context. We then turn to the microeconomic tools that we will employ in our analysis including the concepts of efficiency and equity and the basics of markets. We then consider the determinants of health at the population level before turning to the individual level demand for health and the nature of health care as an economic commodity. We then move to consider the demand

for health care and health care insurance. Our focus then turns to the supply of health care where we look at the role and behavior of the physician before considering methods of economic evaluation and an analysis of the pharmaceutical sector.

Meeting Details

The course contents are delivered online(asynchronously), covering one or two chapters of the text per week.

Important Links

- [Mosaic](#)
- [Avenue to Learn](#)
- [Student Accessibility Services - Accommodations](#)
- [McMaster University Library](#)
- [eReserves](#)

Course Learning Outcomes

Students who successfully complete this course will be able to:

1. Explain and compare key features of health and health care systems, particularly in Canada.
2. Use microeconomic frameworks to analyse health, health care, and health-related behaviours.
3. Analyse determinants of health and patterns of health care use, including the role of uncertainty and insurance.
4. Interpret how incentives and institutional structures influence health care supply and pharmaceutical markets.
5. Apply economic reasoning to evaluate health policy issues, including trade-offs between efficiency and equity.

Course Learning Goals

1. To understand health systems and their performance (Canada + international).
2. To understand how microeconomic principles apply to health and health care.
3. To understand determinants of health and behaviour in health care markets.
4. To think critically about health policy using economic concepts of efficiency and equity.

Materials and Fees

Title: Health Economics

ISBN: 9780666386199

Authors: Jeremiah E. Hurley

Publication Date: 2010

Edition: First

Textbook Listing: <https://campusstore.mcmaster.ca/Course/campus>

An electronic version of the text is available for sale through the campus bookstore McMaster University Campus Store with Immediate Access with a cost of \$40 or a regular price of \$45.95. A printed version of the text is also available with the ISBN: 9 780 666 386 298 for \$72.95

Course Evaluation

<u>Component</u>	<u>Date</u>	<u>Weight (% of final grade)</u>
Quizzes (6)	Weekly on Monday (except May 18)	60% (10% each)
Final	Jun 18 6.30-8pm EST	40%

Course Evaluation Details

Quizzes

These will consist of multiple-choice questions and short answer or True/False/Explain questions in the style of the questions at the end of each chapter of the text. The material covered will be that presented in the previous week. You will generally have 1 hour (+accommodations) to complete each quiz on Monday between 12:00AM and 11:59PM EST. You choose the 1 hour (+accommodations) time slot which works best for you. An exception to this general rule is for Victoria Day (May 18th) where the quiz covering material from week 2 will be held on Tuesday May 19.

Final

The final will cover material from weeks 1 to 7 and consist of multiple-choice questions and short answer or True/False/Explain questions in the style of the questions at the end of each chapter of the text. You will have 1.5hrs (+accommodations) to complete the final beginning at 6.30PM EST on Thursday June 18th.

- All evaluation components will be administered through A2L.
- You are expected to complete each evaluation component without the aid of other students, friends, search engines, online discussion forums, generative AI, or any other resource apart from what you have learnt when reviewing the material in the prior week.

Grading Scale

Grade	Equivalent Grade Point	Equivalent Percentages
A+	12	90-100
A	11	85-89
A-	10	80-84
B+	9	77-79
B	8	73-76
B-	7	70-72
C+	6	67-69
C	5	63-66
C-	4	60-62
D+	3	57-59
D	2	53-56
D-	1	50-52
F	0	0-49

Course Schedule

Material

Chapter-Week: Start

1. Health and Health Care Systems	1 - week 1: May 4
2. Efficiency and Equity	2 - week 2: May 11
3. The Basics of Markets I	3 - week 3: May 18
4. The Basics of Markets II	3 - week 3: May 18
5. Determinants of Population health	6 - week 4: May 25
6. Individual level Demand for and Production of Health	5 - week 4: May 25
7. Health Care as an Economic Commodity	7 - week 5: June 1
8. The Demand for Health Care	8 - week 5: June 1
9. The Demand for Health Care Insurance	9 - week 6: June 8
10. Physicians, Their Practices...	13-week 6: June 8
11. Methods of Economic Evaluation	4 - week 7: June 15
12. Pharmaceuticals	15-week 7: June 15

Late Assignments

As quizzes are held within a 24 hour period and automatically close after that period it is not possible to submit a quiz after the due date without contacting the instructor. See below for information on missed quizzes.

Absences, Missed Work or Illness

If you expect that you will be unable to complete a quiz on the prescribed date you must contact the instructor prior to the assigned date to arrange an alternative-otherwise you will normally receive a grade of zero for that component.

If you find that you were unable unexpectedly to complete a quiz on the prescribed date for health or personal reasons, you should submit an MSAF (through MOSAIC) no later than four calendar days following the day that the quiz should have been completed.

You must contact the instructor no later than 1 calendar day after submitting the MSAF request to arrange for an extension for submitting the quiz or to arrange an alternative assessment.

Turnitin.com

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For students using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. A2L, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster's use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

Course Modification

The instructor and university reserve the right to modify elements of the course during the term. The university may change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances. If either type of modification becomes necessary, reasonable notice and communication with the students will be given with an explanation and the opportunity to comment on changes. It is the responsibility of the student to check their McMaster email and course websites weekly during the term and to note any changes.

Generative AI

Generative AI: Use Prohibited

Students are not permitted to use generative AI in this course. In alignment with [McMaster academic integrity policy](#), it "shall be an offence knowingly to ... submit academic work for assessment that was purchased or acquired from another source". This includes work created by generative AI tools. Also state in the policy is the following, "Contract Cheating is the act of "outsourcing of student work to third parties" (Lancaster & Clarke, 2016, p. 639) with or without payment." Using Generative AI tools is a form of contract cheating. Charges of academic dishonesty will be brought forward to the Office of Academic Integrity.

APPROVED ADVISORY STATEMENTS

Academic Integrity

You are expected to exhibit honesty and use ethical behaviour in all aspects of the learning process. Academic credentials you earn are rooted in principles of honesty and academic integrity. **It is your responsibility to understand what constitutes academic dishonesty.**

Academic dishonesty is to knowingly act or fail to act in a way that results or could result in unearned academic credit or advantage. This behaviour can result in serious consequences, e.g. the grade of zero on an assignment, loss of credit with a notation on the transcript (notation

reads: “Grade of F assigned for academic dishonesty”), and/or suspension or expulsion from the university. For information on the various types of academic dishonesty please refer to the [Academic Integrity Policy](https://secretariat.mcmaster.ca/university-policies-proceduresguidelines/), located at <https://secretariat.mcmaster.ca/university-policies-proceduresguidelines/>

The following illustrates only three forms of academic dishonesty:

- plagiarism, e.g. the submission of work that is not one’s own or for which other credit has been obtained.
- improper collaboration in group work.
- copying or using unauthorized aids in tests and examinations.

Authenticity / Plagiarism

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For courses using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. Avenue to Learn, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. **All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld** (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster’s use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

Email Communication

Effective September 1, 2010, it is the policy of the Faculty of Social Sciences that all e-mail communication sent from students to instructors (including Tasks), and from students to staff, must originate from the student's own McMaster University e-mail account. This policy protects confidentiality and confirms the identity of the student. It is the student's responsibility to ensure that communication is sent to the university from a McMaster account. If an instructor becomes aware that a communication has come from an alternate address, the instructor may not reply at his/her/their discretion.

Courses with an On-line Element

Some courses may use on-line elements (e.g. e-mail, Avenue to Learn, LearnLink, web pages, capa, Moodle, ThinkingCap, etc.). Students should be aware that, when they access the electronic components of a course using these elements, private information such as first and last names, usernames for the McMaster e-mail accounts, and program affiliation may become apparent to all other students in the same course. The available information is dependent on the technology used. Continuation in a course that uses on-line elements will be deemed

consent to this disclosure. If you have any questions or concerns about such disclosure, please discuss this with the course instructor.

Online Proctoring

Some courses may use online proctoring software for tests and exams. This software may require students to turn on their video camera, present identification, monitor and record their computer activities, and/or lock/restrict their browser or other applications/software during tests or exams. This software may be required to be installed before the test/exam begins.

Conduct Expectations

As a McMaster student, you have the right to experience, and the responsibility to demonstrate, respectful and dignified interactions within all of our living, learning and working communities. These expectations are described in the [Code of Student Rights & Responsibilities](#) (the “Code”). All students share the responsibility of maintaining a positive environment for the academic and personal growth of all McMaster community members, **whether in person or online.**

It is essential that students be mindful of their interactions online, as the Code remains in effect in virtual learning environments. The Code applies to any interactions that adversely affect, disrupt, or interfere with reasonable participation in University activities. Student disruptions or behaviours that interfere with university functions on online platforms (e.g. use of Avenue 2 Learn, WebEx or Zoom for delivery), will be taken very seriously and will be investigated. Outcomes may include restriction or removal of the involved students’ access to these platforms.

Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities

Students with disabilities who require academic accommodation must contact [Student Accessibility Services](#) (SAS) at 905-525-9140 ext. 28 652 or sas@mcmaster.ca to make arrangements with a Program Coordinator. For further information, consult McMaster University’s [Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities](#) policy.

Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work

In the event of an absence for medical or other reasons, students should review and follow the [Policy on Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work](#).

Academic Accommodation for Religious, Indigenous, or Spiritual Observances (RISO)

Students requiring academic accommodation based on religious, indigenous or spiritual observances should follow the procedures set out in the [RISO](#) policy. Students should submit their request to their Faculty Office ***normally within 10 working days*** of the beginning of

term in which they anticipate a need for accommodation or to the Registrar's Office prior to their examinations. Students should also contact their instructors as soon as possible to make alternative arrangements for classes, assignments, and tests.

Copyright and Recording

Students are advised that lectures, demonstrations, performances, and any other course material provided by an instructor include copyright protected works. The Copyright Act and copyright law protect every original literary, dramatic, musical and artistic work, **including lectures** by University instructors.

The recording of lectures, tutorials, or other methods of instruction may occur during a course. Recording may be done by either the instructor for the purpose of authorized distribution, or by a student for the purpose of personal study. Students should be aware that their voice and/or image may be recorded by others during the class. Please speak with the instructor if this is a concern for you.

Extreme Circumstances

The University reserves the right to change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances (e.g., severe weather, labour disruptions, etc.). Changes will be communicated through regular McMaster communication channels, such as McMaster Daily News, Avenue to Learn and/or McMaster email.